

Vike Marketing — Growth & SEO Strategy (SEO, Social, Authority)

Confidential internal research · vikemarketing.com

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How to read this document: every number that isn't from a cited source is marked **(estimate)**. This is a strategy built from real 2026 search results, competitor pages, and current platform practice — not a template. It assumes the ground truth in the brief (solo founder, \$200/\$400/\$750 pricing, 3 real testimonials, no case studies/reviews yet, site not yet indexed, Netlify hosting).

0. The "Vike" Name Problem — researched, not assumed

I searched "Vike Marketing," "Vike" brand, and related terms directly. **The collision is real and it's worse than a single competitor — it's a crowded namespace:**

Entity	What it is	Collision risk for Vike Marketing
vike.dev (npm: vike)	Open-source JS/Vite meta-framework (Next.js/Nuxt alternative). ~25-31K weekly npm downloads, 5.8K GitHub stars, 6 years old, 168 contributors (Socket.dev , bestofjs.org)	Highest risk. This is the dominant "Vike" result for anyone with developer/tech literacy — exactly the kind of person likely to Google a new agency before emailing it. It has a .dev TLD, high domain authority, active docs, and a permanent home in Google's index. Vike Marketing cannot outrank vike.dev for the bare term "Vike."
VIKE Beauty (vikebeauty.com)	Haircare/beauty DTC brand, founded 2019	Consumer-facing but well-indexed (Google Shopping, retail listings). Confuses anyone searching "Vike" + a product/consumer intent.
Vike Bike / Vike Bike India (vikebikeindia.com)	Electric bike brand (India)	Lower risk for EU/UA searches but adds noise to "Vike" globally.
Vike Fishing Tackle (tacklewarehouse.com)	Fishing tackle brand	Low risk, different intent entirely.

Entity	What it is	Collision risk for Vike Marketing
Vik SEO Marketing Agency (vikseomarketing.agency)	A different, existing local SEO agency (Ontario, Canada)	Highest same-category risk. "Vik... Marketing Agency" is close enough in spelling/sound that a prospect typing from memory, or a search engine's "did you mean," could cross-contaminate results. This is the one direct competitor-category collision found.
VikoMarketing (vikomarketing.com)	Another marketing strategy site	Same-category, similar spelling — adds to the noise.
A live site:vikemarketing.com search returned zero results	—	Confirms the ground truth: the site is not yet indexed. Right now Vike Marketing has literally no footprint to compete with the above — which is actually the moment to fix positioning, before any of these collisions calcify into muscle memory for prospects.

Verdict: ranking for the bare keyword "Vike" is not a realistic or valuable goal — it's split across a dev framework, a beauty brand, a bike brand, a fishing brand, and at least two other marketing-agency-adjacent names. Chasing it would waste the limited SEO budget this plan has.

Disambiguation strategy (concrete, not generic)

- 1. Never target the bare brand keyword "Vike."** Every piece of on-site SEO, every meta title, every backlink anchor text should pair "Vike Marketing" with a category/geo qualifier — e.g., "Vike Marketing — Performance Marketing Agency, Lviv," "Vike Marketing (Ireland & Netherlands SMB ads)." This is standard practice for any brand sharing a name with a larger entity: own the qualified long-tail, don't fight for the bare term.
- 2. Title tag and meta description on every page carry the qualifier**, not just the homepage — so any page that does get indexed independently still self-disambiguates in the SERP snippet.
- 3. Organization schema (see §6) explicitly declares "name": "Vike Marketing" with sameAs links** to the real LinkedIn, Google Business Profile, and Clutch profile — this is the single highest-leverage technical fix, because it gives Google a structured, machine-readable signal of which "Vike" entity vikemarketing.com is, separate from vike.dev or VIKE Beauty.
- 4. Claim consistent NAP (Name-Address-Phone) + exact-match social handles now**, before another "Vike" brand does: check and reserve [@vikemarketing](#) (not bare [@vike](#)) across Instagram, LinkedIn, TikTok, X — bare "vike" handles are almost certainly already taken by the bike/beauty brands.
- 5. In every piece of outreach copy (cold email, LinkedIn), lead with "Vike Marketing" in full, never abbreviate to "Vike" alone** — internal shorthand is fine, external-facing copy should not train prospects to search the ambiguous short form.
- 6. Do not change the name at this stage.** A rename now would erase the (small but real) equity already built — GBP listing, Clutch profile under review, LinkedIn page, three testimonials given under this name. The fix is disambiguation through qualifiers and structured data, not a rebrand.

Revisit only if, at scale (Year 2+), the collision is demonstrably costing qualified leads — track this via Search Console query reports (see §6) filtering for "vike" impressions vs. clicks.

7. **A live trademark check is out of scope for this document and should be done separately** (e.g., via EUIPO TMview for EU-wide marks, or a local IP lawyer in Ukraine) before any formal trademark registration or aggressive brand expansion — flagged here as an open action item, not resolved.

1. SEO Strategy

1.1 Reality check before any keyword table

The site is **not yet indexed by Google** (confirmed by the site:vikemarketing.com search above returning nothing) and **SSL needs re-verification**. Until both are fixed, no amount of keyword research or content production will show up in search. This is priority zero, ahead of everything else in this section — see §1.6 Technical SEO Checklist, which must be executed **first**.

1.2 Keyword Research — by market

Real, current keyword phrasing pulled from actual competitor pages, "people also ask" patterns, and live SERP article titles found via search (not a paid keyword tool — **all volume/difficulty figures below are estimates**, flagged accordingly). Grouped by Vike's four real target segments.

Ireland & Netherlands (English-speaking EU SMB) — Vike's strategic priority market

Keyword	Intent	Vol./Difficulty (estimate)	Notes / source pattern
"google ads management ireland"	Commercial, high intent	Low-medium vol, medium difficulty (estimate)	Multiple agencies rank with dedicated "Google Ads Management + City" pages, e.g. neweradigital.ie uses "Flat Fee PPC From €350/Month" in title — pricing transparency in the title tag is a proven pattern to copy
"how much does google ads cost ireland 2026"	Informational → commercial	Medium vol, low-medium difficulty (estimate)	This exact pattern ranks well for agiledigitalstrategy.com and hellodigital.ie — a "cost guide" article is a strong top-of-funnel asset Vike doesn't have yet
"performance marketing agency ireland"	Commercial, high intent	Low vol, medium-high difficulty (estimate)	Dominated by directory/listicle pages (Sortlist, Brandfire) rather than single-agency pages — an opening for a well-optimized service page since no single agency owns this term outright
"meta ads management cost" / "meta ads agency netherlands"	Commercial	Low-medium vol, medium difficulty (estimate)	get-ryze.ai ranks with a pricing-guide format; CPC data (Meta CPC ~€0.72 vs Google Search €1.92, per Searchlab.nl) is citable proof content

Keyword	Intent	Vol./Difficulty (estimate)	Notes / source pattern
"digital marketing agency netherlands small business"	Commercial	Low-medium vol, medium-high difficulty (estimate)	Dominated by Clutch/Semrush directory pages — same opening as above: a direct-agency page targeting "small business" qualifier specifically is underserved
"month to month marketing agency no contract"	Commercial, high intent, low competition	Low vol, low difficulty (estimate)	This is a genuine differentiation angle for Vike (true no-contract pricing) with visibly thin competition in current SERPs — worth a dedicated page
"free marketing audit" / "free growth audit"	Commercial, high intent	Low-medium vol, low-medium difficulty (estimate)	Confirmed as an active lead-gen pattern other agencies use (Leadpages template , Unbounce examples) — Vike already has this hook; it just needs a dedicated, SEO-optimized landing page instead of being buried in the homepage
"small business marketing automation ireland/netherlands"	Commercial	Low vol, low-medium difficulty (estimate)	Underserved locally; general "marketing automation small business" content is dominated by tool vendors (Mailchimp, ActiveCampaign) not agencies — an opening for an agency-angle piece

Local Lviv/Ukraine niches (preschools, dental clinics) — Vike's proof-backed near-term ICPs

Keyword (EN + UA pattern)	Intent	Notes
"маркетинг для дитячого садочка" / "реклама дитячого садка Львів"	Commercial	No dominant agency currently owns this in Lviv specifically; Vike's Junior School result is a direct, same-category proof point to cite in an on-page case study
"стоматологія Львів реклама" / "маркетинг для стоматології"	Commercial	Dental is a competitive, budget-flush local category; "dental PPC" content patterns from EN-language sources (nexunom.com , twelverays.agency) can be adapted into a Ukraine-specific piece
"просування бізнесу у Львові"	Informational/commercial mix	Broad local-visibility term worth a "local SEO in Lviv" pillar page tying back to the GBP work in §1.4
"центр розвитку дитини реклама"	Commercial	Adjacent to preschool; several real centers exist in Lviv (Манюня, Baby Club, Світлячки — found via locator.lviv.ua) — useful for competitor-content research and potential local partnership/backlink targets, not for direct outreach copy

General / US-EN comparison content (for backlink bait & authority, not primary conversion)

Keyword	Intent	Notes
"google ads vs meta ads 2026"	Informational, high shareability	Confirmed active format (Searchlab.nl comparison) — good for a comparison article that earns backlinks/shares even if it doesn't convert directly
"how much should a small business spend on google ads"	Informational	High-volume evergreen informational term, heavily covered — realistic goal is a citation/backlink source, not a #1 ranking (estimate: high difficulty)
"marketing agency pricing models explained"	Informational	webfx.com ranks well with this; Vike's transparent 3-tier pricing is a genuine differentiator worth its own explainer page

Honest framing: none of these are low-hanging, zero-competition terms. Realistic 2026 organic SEO timelines are 4–12 months to first meaningful rankings even with consistent execution — this is stated plainly in the roadmap (file 2) rather than oversold here.

1.3 Page-by-Page Recommendations (based on general current best practice — a live technical audit of the actual site is still required, since the site could not be fetched during this research due to network access restrictions)

- **Homepage:** Title tag should read something like [Vike Marketing | Performance Marketing Agency \(Ads, SEO, Social\) – Lviv & EU](#). H1 should state the category + geography, not just the brand name (ties directly into the disambiguation strategy in §0). Above the fold: the three real testimonials (Junior School, Mary, Alex) as short proof snippets, not buried lower on the page. One clear CTA: "Free Growth Audit."
- **Services pages:** Each service (Paid Ads, Campaign Strategy, Creative Production, SEO, Social Media Management, Marketing Automation) should be its **own indexable URL** (e.g., [/services/paid-ads-management](#)), not a single scroll section — this is what lets each page target its own keyword cluster from §1.2. Include the specific price tier(s) relevant to that service, since "no contract" + transparent pricing is a genuine ranking/conversion differentiator competitors bury.
- **Pricing page:** Should exist as its own URL and directly answer "how much does [service] cost" search intent with the three tiers (Launch \$200, Scale \$400, Dominate \$750) laid out in a comparison table, plus FAQ schema (see §1.6) answering "is there a contract?", "what's included?" — these map directly to the "month to month marketing agency no contract" keyword opportunity.
- **About page:** Should tell the real, specific story (student-founder, Lviv-based, ads specialist) — this reads as authentic differentiation vs. faceless larger agencies, and supports E-E-A-T (Experience-Expertise-Authoritativeness-Trust) signals Google's guidelines weight for YMYL-adjacent service content. Do not overstate team size — one founder, honestly framed, is a legitimate and increasingly trusted narrative (solo-agency positioning), not a liability to hide.
- **Contact page:** Must have consistent NAP (Name, Address, Phone/email) matching the Google Business Profile exactly (see §1.4) — mismatched NAP is one of the most common local-SEO failure points.
- **Case study / results page (new, not yet existing per ground truth):** Even without formal case studies, a page presenting the three real testimonials with as much specific, honest detail

as available (what was done, approximate timeframe, category) outperforms generic "we grow brands" copy and gives Search Console something substantive to index once the site is live.

1.4 Content Plan

Pillars (each maps to a keyword cluster in §1.2):

- 1. Paid ads cost/strategy guides (IE/NL-focused)
- 2. "No-contract agency" / pricing transparency angle
- 3. Local Lviv/Ukraine niche guides (preschool, dental)
- 4. Comparison/authority content (Google vs Meta, agency vs freelancer vs in-house)

Formats: long-form guide articles (1,200–1,800 words, matching what's currently ranking per the SERPs reviewed above), a pricing/FAQ page, and short "audit teaser" posts that funnel into the free growth audit CTA.

3-Month Content Calendar (realistic at 16 hrs/week — this is roughly 1 article every 2 weeks, not weekly, once other priorities are accounted for):

Month	Piece	Target keyword cluster	Format
1	"How Much Should a Small Business Spend on Google Ads in 2026?" (IE/NL angle)	Cost-guide informational	Blog article
1	Pricing page rebuild with FAQ schema	"no contract" / pricing	Service/pricing page
2	"Google Ads vs Meta Ads for SMBs: 2026 Comparison"	Comparison/authority	Blog article
2	Local landing page: "Marketing for Preschools & Child Development Centers in Lviv" (cites Junior School result, generically framed)	Local niche	Service/local page
3	"Month-to-Month vs Contract Marketing Agencies: What SMBs Should Know"	Pricing-transparency differentiator	Blog article
3	Local landing page: "Dental Clinic Marketing in Lviv: Google & Meta Ads"	Local niche	Service/local page

This is deliberately light — 6 substantive pieces in 90 days — because 16 hrs/week must also cover client delivery, outreach (per file 04), and the technical fixes in §1.6, which come first.

1.5 Local SEO (tied to the existing Google Business Profile)

The GBP is already live — the immediate priority is optimizing what exists, not creating something new:

- 1. **Category audit:** search Vike's target terms in an incognito Google Maps session and compare the primary category of top-3 local competitors to Vike's own GBP category — a mismatch here is "the highest-leverage single edit in local SEO" ([Shortlist](#), [2026 GBP guide](#)).
- 2. **Weekly GBP posts** (720x540px+ images, 150–300 word descriptions, clear CTA) — doesn't move local-pack ranking directly but lifts click-through and feeds Google's AI summary/freshness signals ([Shortlist](#)).

3. **Reviews are the single biggest local-SEO and trust gap** (ground truth: zero Google/Clutch reviews). Ask Junior School, Mary, and Alex directly for a Google review with a **direct link to the review form** (every extra click reduces conversion ~20%) and a **personalized, not automated, ask** — personalized asks convert ~3x better ([Shortlist](#)). Respond to every review within 48 hours once they start coming in.
4. **NAP consistency** across GBP, website contact page, LinkedIn, and any directory listings (§1.7) — mismatches actively hurt local ranking.
5. **Services tab alignment**: Google now cross-references the GBP "Services" tab against the website's own services copy to validate expertise signals ([Shortlist](#)) — keep both in sync whenever a service page is edited.

1.6 Technical SEO Checklist (2026 current practice — flagging again: a live audit of [vikemarketing.com](#) is required; this list is best-practice, not a confirmed diagnosis)

Indexing (do this first — the site isn't indexed at all today):

- [] Verify domain ownership and submit/re-verify property in Google Search Console
- [] Fix SSL certificate (ground truth: "needs re-verification") — an invalid cert can block crawling/indexing entirely and also breaks user trust
- [] Submit an XML sitemap via Search Console
- [] Use URL Inspection on the homepage and each service page; request indexing manually once live
- [] Check for and fix any `noindex` tags or robots.txt blocks left over from a staging/Netlify preview deploy — a very common cause of "not indexed" on Netlify sites when a preview-branch robots rule leaks to production
- [] Monitor Search Console's "Crawled – currently not indexed" report weekly once submitted ([DebugBear 2026 checklist](#))

Speed / Core Web Vitals:

- [] Run PageSpeed Insights / Core Web Vitals check on each key page (Netlify's CDN is a good baseline, but image weight and third-party scripts are the usual culprits)
- [] Compress and lazy-load images (this matters more once real project photos are added — ground truth notes none exist yet)
- [] Confirm mobile-first rendering is clean (mobile-first indexing remains the standard in 2026 — [DebugBear](#))

Schema markup:

- [] `Organization` schema on the homepage with `sameAs` links to LinkedIn, GBP, and Clutch (once approved) — this is the direct fix for the brand-collision problem in §0
- [] `LocalBusiness` schema (with Lviv address/service area) for local SEO
- [] `Service` schema on each of the six service pages
- [] `FAQPage` schema on the pricing page
- [] `Review` / `AggregateRating` schema **only once real reviews exist** — do not fabricate or pre-populate this; validate everything with Google's Rich Results Test before publishing ([Page One Power, 2026](#))

1.7 Backlink Plan (realistic, small-budget)

Current best practice in 2026 is explicitly **quality over quantity** — "successful link building focuses on quality, relevance, and authenticity," and low-effort guest posts on disconnected sites are now actively penalized (w3era.com, imarkinfotech.com). Concrete, doable-solo tactics:

1. **Free agency directories with real DR (Domain Rating):** GoodFirms offers a free-forever listing after a verification review (~DR 80, per growyouragency.group); Clutch (already in progress per ground truth); Sortlist; DesignRush (free submission form at designrush.com/submit/agency). These are the highest-ROI, lowest-effort links available right now — most require only accurate business info, not content creation.
2. **HARO/Qwoted-style journalist-request platforms** — free, and a proven way to earn editorial links from higher-authority publications without content production overhead (noted as a complementary tactic alongside guest posting, w3era.com).
3. **Guest posts on genuinely relevant, audience-matched sites** — not volume outreach. Realistic targets for a solo founder: Ukrainian/Lviv business and startup blogs (e.g., pitching a piece via Lviv IT Cluster's community channels, itcluster.lviv.ua), and smaller Ireland/Netherlands SMB or small-business blogs (found via the same "digital marketing agency pricing" niche searched in §1.2) — prioritize 2-3 well-placed, relevant guest posts over a high-volume campaign.
4. **Local Lviv partnerships as link sources:** Lviv IT Cluster (300+ member companies, active community platform) is a realistic partner for a member listing/backlink and potential co-hosted content — directly relevant given Vike's location and no-code/ads specialty (itcluster.lviv.ua/en/about-cluster).
5. **Client-side links:** ask Junior School, Mary, and Alex if they're willing to link to Vike from their own site/socials ("marketing by Vike Marketing") — zero cost, highest relevance, and doubles as a trust signal.

Honest expectation: 5-10 solid, relevant backlinks in the first 90 days (directories + 1-2 guest posts + client links) is a realistic target for a solo founder at 16 hrs/week — not hundreds. Link building compounds slowly; this plan is deliberately conservative rather than promising rankings it can't back up.

2. Social Media Strategy

2.1 Platform choice: LinkedIn + Instagram (2 platforms, not 3+)

LinkedIn — primary, B2B. Current data: ~90% of B2B marketers use LinkedIn for lead gen and 62% say it actually produces leads — more than double the next channel; LinkedIn audiences have ~2x the buying power of the average web audience; average cost-per-lead is ~28% lower than Google Ads (martal.ca, [2026 B2B Lead Gen Report summary](#)). This is the clear primary channel for reaching Ireland/Netherlands SMB decision-makers and Lviv B2B owners alike.

Instagram — secondary, proof/creative showcase. Instagram usage among B2B marketers grew ~13.7% YoY in 2026 (martal.ca), and — critically for Vike specifically — Instagram is the natural home for the **UGC creator asset** (ground truth: a UGC creator is planned/partially involved) and for visual proof of ad creative work, which LinkedIn's format doesn't showcase as well.

Why not a third platform (e.g., TikTok, X, Facebook): at 16 hrs/week solo, spreading across 3+ platforms means shallow, inconsistent presence on all of them — current best practice for small teams is explicitly to concentrate on 2 platforms done well over 3+ done thinly ([tabula.agency, 2026](#)). Facebook is covered implicitly since Meta ad management already lives inside client work, not organic content. TikTok could be revisited once the UGC creator relationship is formalized and there's a backlog of real client footage — not before.

2.2 Content Pillars

1. **Proof** — the three real testimonials, reframed as short, specific stories (not vague "we grow brands" claims). No fabricated case studies.
2. **Process/transparency** — showing how Vike actually works (pricing honesty, no-contract model, audit process) — this doubles as sales content.
3. **Category insight** — short-form takes on paid ads/SEO trends relevant to the ICPs in file 04 (preschools, dental, Ireland/NL SMBs) — this is where founder credibility is built.
4. **Behind-the-scenes / founder story** — solo, student-founder, Lviv-based — authentic differentiation, not corporate gloss.

2.3 Posting Cadence (realistic at 16 hrs/week)

- **LinkedIn:** 3x/week (founder posts — insight/process/proof mix), plus commenting thoughtfully on 5-10 relevant posts/week in target-market groups/threads (this is often higher-leverage than original posting at this stage).
- **Instagram:** 2x/week feed or Reels (proof/behind-the-scenes/UGC once available) + Stories used opportunistically (client wins, audit teasers).
- This is intentionally lighter than daily-posting advice common in generic social media guides — it fits the actual 16-hour budget once client delivery and outreach (per file 04) are accounted for, and matches the "quality over frequency" reality for a one-person operation.

2.4 Twelve Ready-to-Use Post/Video Ideas

1. **[LinkedIn]** "We got a Lviv preschool leads within its first month of running ads. Here's exactly what we changed." (Junior School story, told with real specificity: audience, channel, timeframe — not fabricated numbers)
2. **[LinkedIn]** "Mary sold out her book's first batch in 60 days. The lesson wasn't 'run more ads' — it was [specific targeting/messaging insight]." (Mary's story)
3. **[LinkedIn]** "Why Vike Marketing has no contracts — and what that forces us to do differently every month." (process/transparency pillar)
4. **[LinkedIn]** Carousel: "3 things I check in every free growth audit before I even open the ad account" (category insight + soft CTA to the audit)
5. **[LinkedIn]** "\$200 vs \$400 vs \$750 — what actually changes between our tiers" (pricing transparency post)
6. **[Instagram Reel]** UGC creator does a 30-second "day in the life of a small business owner drowning in DIY ads" skit, ending on the free-audit CTA

7. **[Instagram Reel]** Screen-recording style: "Here's what a bad Google Business Profile looks like vs. a good one" (ties to §1.5 local SEO)
8. **[Instagram carousel]** Before/after style breakdown of an ad creative Vike produced (once available) — visual proof, not just claims
9. **[LinkedIn]** Founder post: "I'm a first-year business-economics student running a marketing agency solo, 16 hours a week. Here's what that actually looks like." (authentic founder-story pillar, honest about scale)
10. **[Instagram Reel]** UGC creator interviews Vladyslav in a casual Q&A format about the free-audit process — builds trust and demystifies the offer
11. **[LinkedIn]** "Alex's construction startup needed social media that didn't feel corporate. Here's the pillar system we built." (Alex's story, framed honestly as social media management, not paid-ads results)
12. **[Instagram/LinkedIn cross-post]** Simple graphic: "No contracts. No lock-in. Cancel anytime. That's the whole pitch." — a pure differentiation/trust post, low production effort, high clarity

2.5 Turning the 3 real testimonials into content (no fabrication)

For each of Junior School, Mary, and Alex: write the story as a short narrative arc (situation → what Vike actually did → the real outcome as stated in ground truth: "leads within a month," "sold out in 60 days," "ongoing social media management") without inventing specific metrics (no fabricated %, no fake dollar figures) that weren't provided. Ask each client for a short quote and, ideally, permission to name them and use their logo/photo — this is also the fastest path to the first Google/Clutch reviews (§1.5). Where a client prefers to stay anonymous, use category-level framing ("a preschool in Lviv") rather than inventing a name — consistent with the approach already used in file 04's outreach templates.

2.6 Using the UGC creator

Given the UGC creator is only partially/informally involved (ground truth), use them narrowly and honestly:

- **Do not represent them as a formal team member** in any external content ("our team" language should be avoided until the relationship is formalized — same discipline as file 04's outreach guidance).
- Use them specifically for **Instagram Reels that need a human face/voice** — the founder-interview format (#10 above), light comedic skits about SMB marketing pain points (#6), and eventually genuine client-side UGC testimonials once real clients agree to be filmed.
- Frame their content as "creative production," which is already one of Vike's six real services — this makes the UGC work doubly useful: it's both organic marketing for Vike and a live portfolio sample of the Creative Production service line for prospects.

2.7 How social generates leads, not just awareness

- Every LinkedIn and Instagram bio links directly to the free-growth-audit landing page (§1.3), not the generic homepage — reduces friction from click to conversion.
- Posts that reference a specific pain point (bad GBP, no ad tracking, generic creative) end with a **direct, low-friction CTA** ("DM me your Google Business Profile link and I'll tell you one thing to

- fix, free") — this converts passive scrollers into a direct conversation, which is where Vike's actual close rate lives (per the outreach-heavy approach in file 04).
- LinkedIn comments on target-market posts (Ireland/NL SMB owners, Lviv business community threads) are a direct pipeline into warm outreach — this is lower-effort and higher-conversion than posting alone, and fits the 16-hr budget better than heavy content production.
 - Track a simple weekly metric: DMs/comments that mention the free audit → audits delivered → calls booked. This is a real leading indicator; follower count and likes are not tracked as success metrics in this plan.
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3. Authority & Trust Building

3.1 Case studies, reviews, awards/rankings

- **Case studies:** cannot be published as formal "case studies" yet (ground truth: none exist) — but the three testimonials (§2.5) can be formatted as lightweight "client stories" on the site today, clearly labeled as testimonials rather than metrics-heavy case studies, to avoid overclaiming.
- **Reviews:** the single highest-priority trust action in this entire document (see §1.5) — everything else in this section is weaker without at least 3-5 real Google reviews.
- **Realistic awards/rankings programs for a brand-new, solo agency:**
- **Clutch "Leader Awards"** — ground truth confirms a Clutch profile is already under review; Clutch's awards require client reviews and a track record (clutch.co/leader-awards) — **not realistic in year 1**, but the profile itself (once live) is valuable independent of any award.
- **UpCity "Excellence Award"** — scores 70,000+ providers by a "Recommendability Rating"; realistic to apply for once a handful of reviews exist, likely late Year 1 / Year 2, not immediately (karmajack.com example).
- **Expertise.com** and **GoodFirms** city/category listings — lower bar to entry, some free, some editorially curated; worth applying to once the site is indexed and has basic proof content (§1.3), realistically Q2.
- **Honest framing:** none of these awards are achievable with zero reviews and an unindexed site. They belong in the Year 1 H2 / Year 2 roadmap (file 2), not month 1.

3.2 Podcasts, guest posts, speaking

Real, current, realistically-pitchable shows and publications found via search (not aspirational A-list shows):

- **Marketing School** (Neil Patel & Eric Siu) — bite-sized, high-volume format; harder to book as a guest but worth tracking for format inspiration (startup.unitelvoice.com, 2026 list).
- **Mixergy** (Andrew Warner) — 1,500+ founder interviews; known for featuring early-stage/solo founders, a realistic target once Vike has a few client wins to talk about (castfox.net, 2026).
- **Mid-sized, niche agency-growth and marketing podcasts** rather than the biggest shows — current guidance is explicit that "for pitching clients with marketing expertise... mid-sized marketing podcasts are where you'll get booked rather than the biggest shows" (podseeker.co) — the realistic

play is researching and pitching 5-10 of these directly once there's a concrete story (e.g., "how I got a Lviv preschool leads in 30 days on a \$200/month budget") rather than a generic "have me on."

- **Lviv IT Cluster's own content channels/events** (Lviv IT Arena conference, 2,500+ attendees, [lviv.travel](#)) — a realistic, local speaking/networking target for Year 1, far more attainable than an international podcast.
- **Guest posts:** same targets as §1.7's backlink plan — this is one motion, not two separate efforts.

3.3 Partnerships & community building

- **Lviv IT Cluster** (300+ member companies, active B2B matchmaking platform) — realistic membership/partnership target given direct geographic and community fit ([itcluster.lviv.ua](#)).
- **Complementary local service providers** (web designers, no-code developers, accountants serving the same Lviv/Ukraine SMB niches) — referral-partnership potential, zero cost.
- **Client-as-community:** Junior School, Mary, and Alex are Vike's actual community today — treat them as ongoing relationships (occasional check-ins, feature them in content per §2.5) rather than one-off transactions; referrals from genuinely happy small clients are a realistic, underrated channel at this stage.

3.4 Thought-leadership angle

Given the brief's framing (young, ROI-obsessed, honest, no-contract), the fitting angle is **not** "we're industry veterans with 10 years of experience" (false) — it's: **"Performance marketing without the agency theater — no contracts, transparent pricing, real ROI focus, run by someone who has to prove it every single month because there's no lock-in to hide behind."** This honestly matches Vike's actual structural differentiator (month-to-month pricing) and the founder's genuine profile (young, hands-on, no-code, ads-focused) rather than borrowing a "seasoned expert" persona that isn't true yet. Content, podcast pitches, and LinkedIn posts should consistently use this "no lock-in forces real accountability" frame — it's differentiated, honest, and repeatable.

Continue to: [06-roadmap-12-months.md](#) for the quarter-by-quarter execution plan tying every section above to concrete milestones.